

We take the work that eats your week and hand it back done.

Most small businesses do not lose time to hard problems. They lose it to the same twenty minutes repeated forty times a day — retyping an order that arrived as a PDF, rebuilding a quote from a price list, copying a lab result into a certificate, chasing a number that lives in a database nobody can query.

We build the systems that absorb that work: intake, decision rules, the write-back into whatever software you already run, and a clean exception path for the cases a person genuinely needs to see. Inside is what we have built, and what changed for the people who run it.

Five automation systems running in client operations. One AI SaaS platform of our own. Every one of them built on the same principle: the machine does the repetition, a person keeps the judgment.

SELECTED WORK

01	Sales Order Automation	03
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OPERATING PRINCIPLES

Three rules we do not break, because they are what make automation safe to trust.

Rules decide. AI reads.

The AI extracts, matches and explains. Prices, tax, spec limits and eligibility are computed by deterministic rules you can read and test. Nothing critical is left to a model's guess.

Exceptions go to humans.

Automation handles the ninety percent that is routine and routes the rest to a person with the source document beside it. Your team stops doing data entry and starts doing judgment.

Everything leaves a trace.

Every automated action records what it saw, what rule it applied and what it wrote. When an auditor, a customer or your accountant asks why, the answer is one click away.

HOW AN ENGAGEMENT RUNS

We start with one workflow, not a transformation programme.

01

Walk the process

We sit with the people doing the work and map what actually happens, including the workarounds nobody documented.

02

Pick the one that pays

We rank candidates by hours consumed, error cost and how contained the change is, then start with a single workflow.

03

Build against reality

We build on your real documents and your real edge cases, integrating with the software you already run rather than replacing it.

04

Run in parallel

The automation runs beside the manual process until its output matches, so nothing is trusted before it has earned it.

05

Hand over

Your team gets documentation, the exception desk and control of the rules — plus monitoring and support from us as volumes grow.

SVC / 01

DISCIPLINE

Order-to-cash operations

INTAKE

Email, PDF, WhatsApp,
customer portals,
spreadsheets

WRITES TO

ERP / accounting system
of record

HUMAN ROLE

Approves exceptions only

Sales Order Automation

Orders that arrive as documents, entered as data — without anyone retyping them.

THE SITUATION

Orders reached the client in every format a customer felt like using: a PDF purchase order attached to an email, a photo of a signed order form on WhatsApp, a line item scribbled in the body of a message, a spreadsheet export from a larger buyer's procurement system. Every one of them ended the same way — a person opening the ERP and typing it in by hand.

That created three costs the business felt but could not isolate. Orders sat unentered for hours or overnight, so stock was allocated late and shipments slipped a day. Typos in SKUs and quantities produced wrong shipments, credit notes and returns that cost far more than the original order was worth. And every peak season meant hiring temporary help just to keep up with data entry, because the process scaled with headcount and nothing else.

WHAT WE BUILT

- **A single intake layer.** One monitored inbox, plus WhatsApp and portal connections, so every incoming order lands in one queue regardless of how the customer chose to send it.
- **Document understanding.** AI extraction reads PDFs, scans, photos and message text into structured line items — customer, product, quantity, requested date, delivery address, reference number.
- **Catalogue matching that learns.** Customers describe products in their own words, not the client's SKUs. The system matches free-text descriptions against the real catalogue and remembers each customer's aliases, so "12mm ply, 8x4, B grade" resolves to the correct part every time after the first.
- **Validation before anything is written.** Price checked against the contracted tier, quantity against minimum order and pack size, availability against live stock, and the account against credit limit and unpaid balance.

CONTINUED OVERLEAF →

SVC / 01 • CONT.

DISCIPLINE

Order-to-cash operations

INTAKE

Email, PDF, WhatsApp,
customer portals,
spreadsheets

WRITES TO

ERP / accounting system
of record

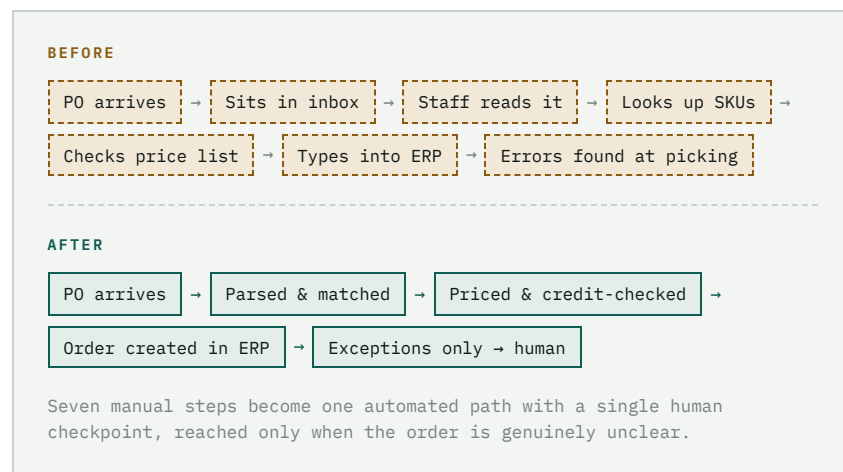
HUMAN ROLE

Approves exceptions only

WHAT WE BUILT / CONTINUED

- **Write-back into the system of record.** Clean orders are created directly in the ERP, with the original document attached to the order so the source is always one click away.
- **An exception desk.** Anything ambiguous — a discontinued item, a price mismatch, an unreadable scan, an over-limit account — is routed to a person with the source document and the system's best interpretation side by side, for a one-click confirm or correct.

THE WORKFLOW, BEFORE AND AFTER



WHAT IT CHANGED

Orders now enter the system in minutes from arrival instead of waiting for someone to get to them, which pulls the entire picking, packing and invoicing chain forward — the business gets paid sooner on the same sales.

Errors that used to surface in the warehouse now surface at intake, where fixing them costs a click instead of a return shipment. And because the workload no longer scales with headcount, the client absorbs seasonal peaks with the same team, while the people who used to key in orders spend that time on customers instead.

SVC / 02

DISCIPLINE

Pre-sales & pricing

INTAKE

RFQ emails, web forms,
spec sheets

ENCODES

Cost build-up, margin &
discount rules

OUTPUT

Branded quote, approval
trail, follow-up

Quotation Automation

Same-day quotes, priced by the rules the business actually agreed to.

THE SITUATION

Quoting was the client's slowest and most valuable process at the same time. A request for quote came in, and someone senior had to dig through supplier cost sheets, look up what this customer paid last time, apply a discount from memory, work out freight, build the document, and send it. It took days when they were busy — and buyers who wait days often buy from whoever answered first.

Worse, the margin discipline lived in one or two people's heads. Different staff quoted the same job at different prices. Discounts got granted that nobody had authorised. Quotes went out and then sat, unfollowed, until they quietly expired, and no one could say what the win rate actually was or which quotes were lost on price.

WHAT WE BUILT

- **RFQ parsing.** Incoming requests — email text, attached spec sheets, drawings and bills of materials — are read into a structured list of what is being asked for, with quantities and specifications.
- **Automatic cost build-up.** Each line is priced from live supplier and internal cost data, with freight, currency conversion, packaging and any surcharge logic applied rather than estimated.
- **The pricing rules, written down.** Volume breaks, customer tiers, contract pricing, minimum margins and approved discount ranges are encoded once, so every quote from every person applies the same policy.
- **Guardrail approvals.** A quote inside policy goes out immediately. Anything below the margin floor or outside the discount band routes to a manager with the numbers and the reason it was flagged.

CONTINUED OVERLEAF →

SVC / 02 • CONT.

DISCIPLINE

Pre-sales & pricing

INTAKE

RFQ emails, web forms,
spec sheets

ENCODES

Cost build-up, margin &
discount rules

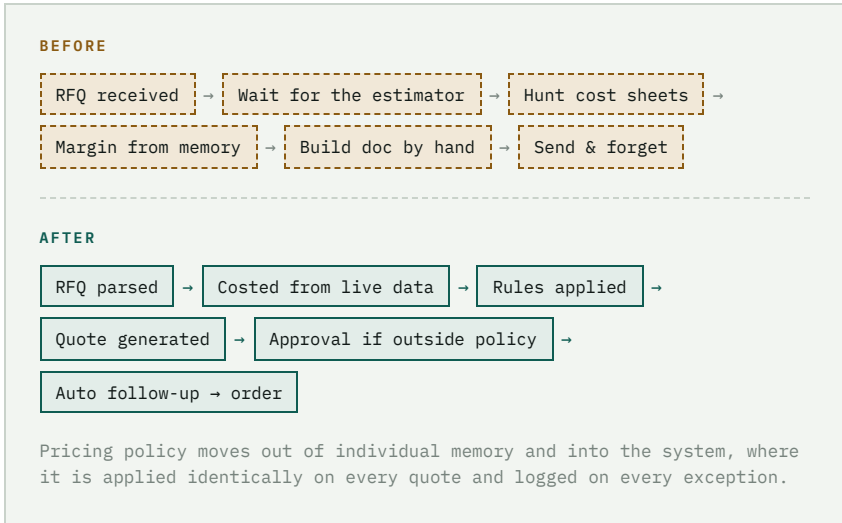
OUTPUT

Branded quote, approval
trail, follow-up

WHAT WE BUILT / CONTINUED

- **Generated documents.** A branded, correctly formatted quotation is produced automatically — line items, terms, validity period, reference number — ready to send or e-sign.
- **Acceptance and follow-up.** Open quotes get automatic reminders on a schedule, and an accepted quote converts straight into a sales order without re-entry.

THE WORKFLOW, BEFORE AND AFTER



WHAT IT CHANGED

The client now answers most quote requests the same day they arrive, which in a competitive bid is frequently the whole difference. Margin stopped leaking through informal discounting, because every price below the floor requires a decision by someone entitled to make it — and that decision is recorded.

Nothing expires unnoticed: open quotes chase themselves, and accepted ones become orders without a second round of typing. For the first time the business can see, by customer and by product line, what it quotes, what it wins, and what it loses.

SVC / 03

DISCIPLINE

Data access & reporting

SITS OVER

ERP tables, SQL
databases, warehouses,
spreadsheets

ACCESS MODEL

Read-only, permission-
scoped

GUARANTEE

Every answer shows its
query

Database AI Integration

The business asks a question in plain language. The database answers it, and shows its working.

THE SITUATION

The client's operational history — every order, product, customer, movement and invoice — sat in their database, and almost nobody could reach it.

Answering “which customers ordered less this quarter than last?” meant asking the one person who could write a query, or exporting to a spreadsheet and pivoting by hand. Requests queued behind that person. Reports that took an hour to build got built once and then went stale.

So decisions got made on instinct and on whatever the standard monthly report happened to show. The data existed, was accurate, and was effectively unavailable to the people whose decisions depended on it.

WHAT WE BUILT

- **A semantic layer in the company's own vocabulary.** We mapped the terms the business actually uses — “active customer”, “net margin”, “overdue”, “slow-moving” — onto the real tables and columns, with the definitions agreed once and applied consistently everywhere.
- **Natural-language querying with hard limits.** Questions are translated into SQL against that model, executed read-only, and bounded by row limits and timeouts. The system cannot write, delete or alter anything.
- **Permission-aware answers.** Access follows the person asking. A sales rep sees their own accounts; a manager sees the region; payroll and cost data stay behind their existing permissions.
- **Answers that show the query.** Every result displays the SQL that produced it and the rows it came from. Numbers are never generated by the model — they are returned by the database, and anyone can verify how.

CONTINUED OVERLEAF →

SVC / 03 • CONT.

DISCIPLINE

Data access & reporting

SITS OVER

ERP tables, SQL
databases, warehouses,
spreadsheets

ACCESS MODEL

Read-only, permission-
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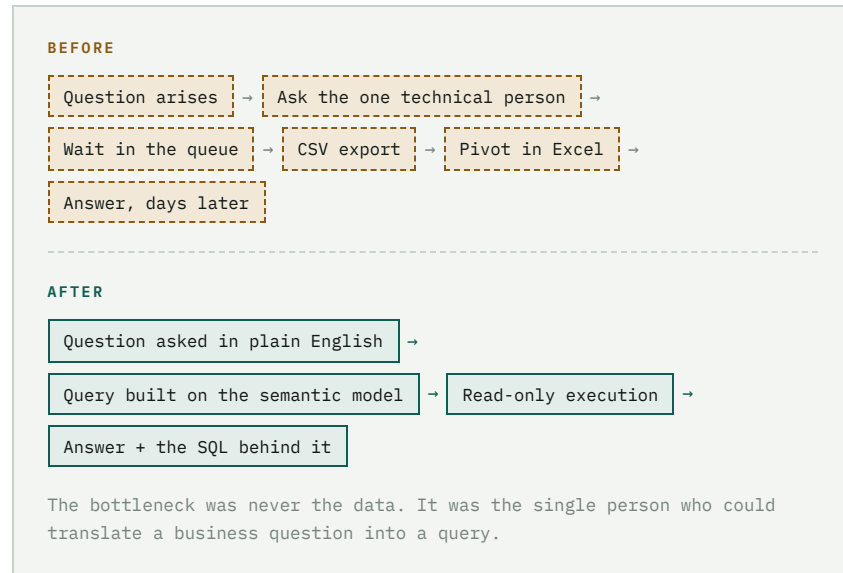
GUARANTEE

Every answer shows its
query

WHAT WE BUILT / CONTINUED

- **Charts and exports on demand.** Results render as tables or charts and drop into a spreadsheet or a slide without a rebuild.
- **Scheduled watchlists.** Recurring questions run themselves — Monday's slow-moving stock, this week's customers trending down, anything overdue past terms — and arrive by email or chat before someone has to think to ask.

THE WORKFLOW, BEFORE AND AFTER



WHAT IT CHANGED

Questions that used to take days now take a sentence, so people ask far more of them — and follow-up questions, which is where the useful findings usually live. The business stopped depending on one individual for access to its own records.

Because every answer carries its query, the numbers are trusted enough to act on and correctable when a definition turns out to be wrong. And the scheduled watchlists changed the posture from asking after the fact to being told early: slow stock, slipping accounts and overdue balances now surface while there is still time to act on them.

SVC / 04

DISCIPLINE

QA / QC laboratory
operations

CAPTURES

Instrument output,
technician entry, batch
records

PRODUCES

Certificates of analysis,
NCR workflow, trends

BUILT FOR

Audit & traceability
requirements

Quality Lab Automation

From sample intake to signed certificate, with the paper trail built in rather than reconstructed.

THE SITUATION

The lab ran on printouts and spreadsheets. Samples were logged in a book, instrument results came off the machine on thermal paper and were transcribed into Excel by hand, spec limits were checked by eye against a laminated sheet, and certificates of analysis were typed up individually and emailed out. Batches waited on that paperwork before they could be released.

Two risks sat inside that. Transcription is where quality records fail — a decimal in the wrong place on a hand-typed result is a serious problem on a document a customer relies on. And traceability existed only in the physical files, so preparing for an audit or a customer complaint meant a person spending days pulling folders to reconstruct what happened to one batch six months ago.

WHAT WE BUILT

- **Sample intake with identity attached.** Every sample is registered on arrival, given a barcoded label, and linked to its batch, product, supplier and the test plan that applies to it — with custody recorded at each handoff.
- **Instrument capture instead of transcription.** Results are read directly from instrument output files and interfaces, so the number on the certificate is the number the instrument produced. Manual entry, where an instrument cannot be connected, is double-checked and attributed.
- **Specification checking on every result.** Each measurement is compared automatically against the correct spec for that product and grade, and flagged pass, warning or out-of-specification the moment it lands.
- **Certificates generated, not typed.** A complete certificate of analysis is produced from the verified results, formatted to the customer's requirements, with method references and the analyst on record.

CONTINUED OVERLEAF →

SVC / 04 • CONT.

DISCIPLINE

QA / QC laboratory
operations

CAPTURES

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technician entry, batch
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PRODUCES

Certificates of analysis,
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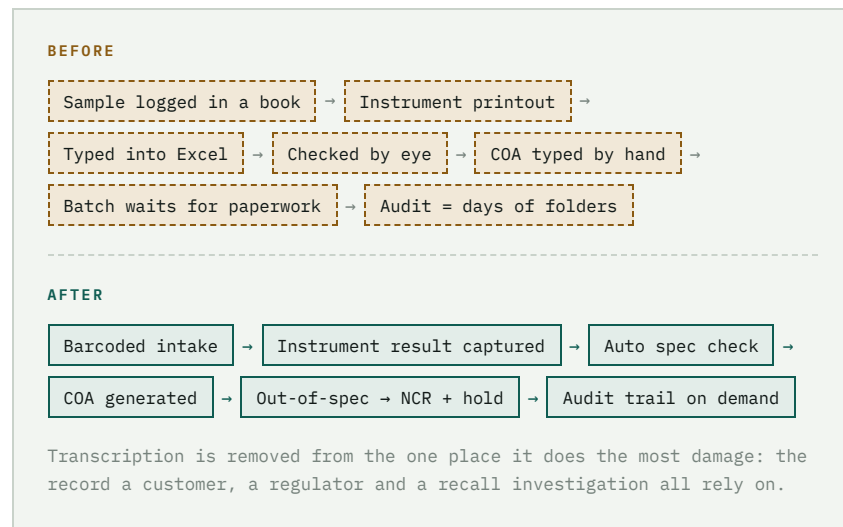
BUILT FOR

Audit & traceability
requirements

WHAT WE BUILT / CONTINUED

- **Non-conformance handled as a workflow.** An out-of-spec result raises a non-conformance, notifies the right people immediately, holds the batch, and tracks investigation, disposition and sign-off to closure.
- **Trending and early warning.** Results are charted over time by product, line, shift and supplier, so drift toward a limit is visible while it is still drift — before it becomes a failed batch.
- **An audit trail that assembles itself.** Raw results, revisions, approvals and timestamps are retained and immutable. Any batch's full history is retrievable on demand.

THE WORKFLOW, BEFORE AND AFTER



WHAT IT CHANGED

Batches are released as soon as the testing is genuinely finished rather than when the paperwork catches up, which frees warehouse space and shortens lead times to customers. The most likely source of an incorrect quality record — a human copying a number — is gone from the routine path.

Out-of-spec results now stop a batch automatically instead of relying on someone noticing, and the escalation is on record from the first minute. And audits changed character entirely: evidence that used to take a week of preparation is produced from the system while the auditor is sitting there.

SVC / 05

DISCIPLINE

Marketing operations

SOURCES

Product data, promotions,
seasonality, past posts

CHANNELS

Instagram, Facebook,
LinkedIn, TikTok, X

HUMAN ROLE

Approves the calendar,
not each post

Social Media Automation

A consistent presence, drafted in the business's own voice and tied to what it is actually selling.

THE SITUATION

The client knew social media mattered and treated it as whatever was left at the end of the week. Posting came in bursts — three in a good week, nothing for a month — because it depended on someone with an operational job finding time to think of something to say, write it, find an image and post it across four platforms individually.

The bigger loss was on the way back in. Comments and direct messages included real buying questions — price, availability, delivery — and they went unanswered for days because nobody owned the inbox. Enquiries that arrived warm went cold in a notifications tab.

WHAT WE BUILT

- **A voice model built from their own approved posts.** Drafts come out sounding like the business rather than like generic marketing copy, with the vocabulary, claims and tone the owner already signed off on.
- **A calendar driven by real events.** The content plan is generated from things that are actually happening — new stock arriving, a promotion, a seasonal peak, a completed project — instead of from a blank page every Monday.
- **Assets assembled with the copy.** Product photography, past project images and templated graphics are matched to each draft and sized correctly per platform.
- **One approval step.** The week's queue arrives for review in a single pass. Approve, edit or reject; nothing publishes without that sign-off.

CONTINUED OVERLEAF →

SVC / 05 • CONT.

DISCIPLINE

Marketing operations

SOURCES

Product data, promotions, seasonality, past posts

CHANNELS

Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, TikTok, X

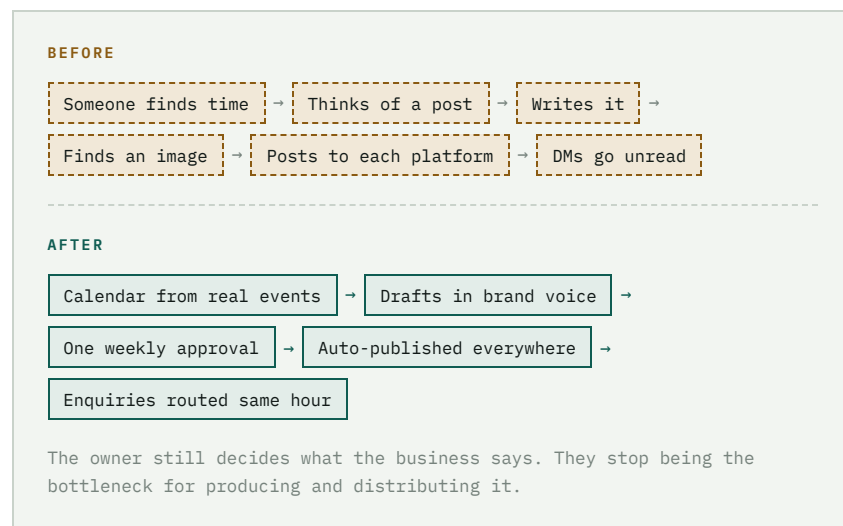
HUMAN ROLE

Approves the calendar, not each post

WHAT WE BUILT / CONTINUED

- **Publishing across channels.** Approved posts go out automatically at scheduled times to every connected platform, in the right format for each.
- **Inbound triage.** Comments and DMs are classified as sales enquiry, support issue, spam or general engagement. Sales enquiries alert the right person immediately with a drafted reply; routine questions get a suggested response; spam is filtered.
- **A weekly report that feeds back.** What reached people, what converted to enquiries, and what did not — used to shape the next calendar rather than filed and forgotten.

THE WORKFLOW, BEFORE AND AFTER



WHAT IT CHANGED

Posting became consistent, which is most of what performance on these platforms rewards — and it stopped competing with operational work for the same person's attention, since a week of content is now reviewed in one sitting.

The content also stopped being generic: because the calendar is driven by stock and promotions, posts point at things customers can actually buy this week. Most valuably, inbound enquiries are answered in the hour rather than the week, so interest that used to evaporate now reaches a salesperson while it is still live.

AI Tax Auditing & Optimisation Engine

A multi-tenant SaaS platform that reads financial documents, audits a return against the rules, and explains every number it produces.

Client automation shows we can make an existing operation faster. This shows we can build and run a regulated software product end to end — because we built one for ourselves, in the least forgiving domain we could have chosen.

Tax is unforgiving for a specific reason: a confident wrong answer is worse than no answer. That constraint shaped the architecture, and the architecture is the part worth showing a prospective client. **The AI never does the arithmetic.** A deterministic, testable rules engine computes every figure — eligibility, thresholds, limits, liability. The AI does what it is genuinely reliable at: reading messy documents, matching them to the right treatment, spotting what is missing or inconsistent, and explaining the result in plain language with a citation to the provision it relied on.

That same split — deterministic where it must be right, AI where it must be flexible — is exactly how we build automation for operating businesses. Tax is simply the version where the consequences of getting it wrong are written into law.

WHAT THE ENGINE DOES

Document ingestion & extraction

Receipts, invoices, statements and slips arrive as photographs, scans and PDFs and come out as structured, categorised financial records — including the messy, unstructured expense documents that automated feeds and government pre-fill services cannot supply.

Audit & anomaly checking

The engine reviews a completed position the way a reviewer would: figures inconsistent with each other, claims outside normal ranges for the profile, duplicate entries, categories that invite scrutiny, and documents that should exist but do not.

Deterministic rules engine

Every calculation runs through a versioned, unit-tested rules engine tied to a specific tax year. Rules are readable, testable and independently verifiable — the requirement that any certification or professional review will impose anyway.

Deduction & credit detection

Extracted records are tested against every credit and deduction the profile is eligible for, so items that only surface when someone reviews the whole picture — rather than one form at a time — get caught.

WHAT THE ENGINE DOES / CONTINUED

Explanations with citations

Each figure comes with a plain-language explanation and a reference to the rule behind it. Users are told why, not just how much — which is what converts a calculated number into one a person is willing to sign.

Forward-looking planning

The same engine runs before the year closes, not just after: liability forecasting and scenario modelling, delivered while there is still time to act rather than as a report on decisions already made.

Full provenance trail

Every number traces back to the source document, the extraction, the rule version and the timestamp. If a figure is ever questioned, the entire chain that produced it can be reconstructed.

Compliance-grade platform

Multi-tenant architecture with per-tenant isolation, role-based access, encryption in transit and at rest, regional data residency, and no raw financial documents sent to third-party model providers without zero-retention terms.

WHY THIS MATTERS TO YOUR BUSINESS

If we hold that standard where an error is a legal liability, the same engineering goes into your order intake.

The techniques are identical across everything in this document: read the document, apply the rule, write the result, explain it, keep the trace. What changes between a tax engine and a sales-order pipeline is the rulebook, not the discipline.

It is also why we will tell you when a workflow is not worth automating. A process that runs twice a month, or one where every case genuinely is an exception, will cost more to automate than it returns — and we would rather say so in the first conversation than discover it in month three.

WE INTEGRATE WITH WHAT YOU ALREADY RUN

Automation should slot into the tools your business is already built on — not replace them.

Replacing working software is expensive, disruptive and usually unnecessary. Every system in this document was built around what the client already used. In practice that has meant:

ERP systems	QuickBooks	Xero	Sage	SQL & Postgres	Google Workspace	Microsoft 365	Shared inboxes
WhatsApp Business	Shopify	Customer portals & EDI	CRM platforms	Lab instruments	E-signature		
Meta & LinkedIn APIs	Spreadsheets						

Tell us the task your team dreads on Monday morning.

We will map it, tell you honestly whether it is worth automating, and scope what it would take. That first conversation costs nothing and takes about thirty minutes.

EMAIL

hello@example.com

WEB

onyxautomation.example

PHONE

+0 000 000 0000

WHAT THAT CONVERSATION NEEDS FROM YOU

01

The workflow, described plainly

Who touches it, how often it runs, and where it currently goes wrong. No process documentation required — a conversation is enough.

02

A handful of real examples

Five actual orders, quotes, lab results or enquiries, messy ones included. Real inputs tell us in an afternoon what a specification cannot.

03

The systems it touches

Whatever the work passes through today — the accounting package, the spreadsheet, the inbox, the database. We build around them.